

Customers Make Companies Successful

As Maruti, popularly known as the people's car, completes 40 years, Chairman **R.C. Bhargava** takes a trip down memory lane and talks about the road ahead for the auto industry

WE HAVE COMPLETED 40 years in India, 40 years since Japan's Suzuki [Motor Corporation] signed an agreement with Maruti Udyog for a joint venture (JV). I think, the thought behind us celebrating this is that in many ways, these 40 years and this partnership have resulted in things happening that were not at

all foreseen 40 years ago. This has surprised most people who were around at that time. Not just in India, [people] in Japan were equally surprised by what happened in India. Mr [Osamu] Suzuki once told me that when they decided to partner with India, he was the only one in favour; everyone else thought... India, public sector, car making... what kind of a decision

is that? That's what most people felt here: carmaking in a socialist India. The existing carmakers were going nowhere. The market was stagnant with 35,000-40,000 cars. Everything was wrong in those days—there were foreign exchange shortages, there were restrictions on all kinds of imports. So, it was really not anything that excited anybody. We should think

THE WHEELS OF TIME

- The dream of building a people's car for India becomes a reality with the signing of an agreement between Japan's Suzuki Motor Corp. and the Government of India-owned Maruti Udyog Ltd. It results in the setting up of a manufacturing facility in Haryana in 1982



First press advertisement issued by the Company, in 1982

Progress. Only change makes it possible. Less than 12 months from now, the first cars and light commercial vehicles from Maruti Udyog Limited will roll out. Vehicles which will change the face and pace of transportation in India. Vehicles using the technology of the 80s under the terms of agreement made with the Suzuki Motor Company of Japan. Highlights of the collaboration: Maruti manufactures vehicles which are now being made and sold worldwide by Suzuki. All improvement advances which Suzuki makes on these vehicles in Japan will be made available to Maruti for 10 years. Uniquely, the President of Suzuki will be a member of Maruti's Board of Directors. Suzuki's



- The first car, the M800, rolls out in December 1983. Then comes the iconic Omni (1984) and Gypsy (1985)

- Maruti Udyog establishes an ecosystem to manufacture automobile components locally. It also exports the first lot of 500 cars to Hungary in 1987



1982

1983

1987